

Elisabeth Leduc

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Labor Economics.

Secondary: Applied Microeconomics, Public/Policy Economics.

CURRENT POSITION

2024 – Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions (MSCA) Postdoctoral Fellow
2022 – Postdoctoral Researcher, Erasmus University Rotterdam.

EDUCATION

2017 – 2022 PhD in Economics, Université Libre de Bruxelles.
2014 – 2016 MSc Business Economics, Université libre de Bruxelles, *Magna cum laude*.
2015 Exchange student, Universidad de Chile.
2011 – 2014 B.Sc. Economics, Université libre de Bruxelles, *Cum laude*.

PAST POSITIONS

2017 – 2022 PhD Researcher, Université libre de Bruxelles (Dulbea).
2022 Visiting researcher, CREST (ENSAE Paris). Sponsor: Arne Uhlenhorff.
2021 Visiting researcher, Erasmus University Rotterdam. Sponsor: Anne Gielen.
2016 – 2017 Consultant – PriceWaterhouse Coopers (Department: Governments, Infrastructure and Network Industries).

RESEARCH

PUBLICATIONS

Leduc, E., & Tojerow, I. (2024). Home Work: Exploring the Labor Market Effects of Subsidizing Domestic Services. *Labour Economics*, 2024, vol. 90.

Abstract: This paper analyzes subsidies for the domestic services sector, an increasingly popular policy to create employment opportunities for low-skilled workers. Using Belgian administrative data, a differences-in-differences approach, and a shift-share instrumental variable, we estimate the local effects of the policy in targeted industries as well as overall effects on the labor market. We find that domestic service subsidies can increase female employment in the subsidized industries as well as the overall employment rate. This increase in employment is primarily driven by an increase in (formal) labor

market participation and, to a lesser extent, a reduction in the rate of participation in unemployment insurance and in other social welfare programs. We also find that these subsidies can lead to an increase in the rate of work incapacity, likely due to the fact they broaden the population that can access the social safety net.

Related material: [policy brief](#), [non-technical video](#), [press](#), [television](#).

De Brouwer, O., Leduc, E., & Tojerow, I. (2023). The Consequences of Job Search Monitoring for the Long-Term Unemployed: Disability Instead of Employment? *Journal of Public Economics*, 224, 104929.

Abstract: We study the effect of job search monitoring (JSM) on individual labor market outcomes of the long-term unemployed. Exploiting the implementation of a JSM program targeted at jobseekers under the age of 49, we set up a regression discontinuity design that credibly identifies the program's causal effect on unemployment, employment, and disability insurance (DI) participation and participation in other social welfare programs within a three-year period. We find that JSM increases exits from unemployment to DI without affecting transitions into employment or other social welfare programs. We further find that the effect of JSM on DI materializes before any sanction can be imposed and monitored individuals are still 10 percentage points more likely to be on DI three years after the start of monitoring. Ultimately, exploring fiscal implications reveals that the decrease in unemployment transfers as a result of JSM is entirely offset by the increase in DI transfers.

Related material: [policy brief](#), [non-technical video](#).

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Training Unemployed Workers to Address Labor Shortages: An Experimental Study on Information Barriers and Employment Effects” *with Ilan Tojerow*

Abstract: We explore whether better information can induce more jobseekers to reskill in occupations that are in shortage. We implement a large-scale field experiment in cooperation with a Public Employment Service in Belgium, in which 100,000 recently unemployed jobseekers receive information about shortage occupations and available training programs. Using a combination of survey and administrative data, we first show that the treatment information generated interest in trainings and increased intentions to enrol. Increases in actual training enrolment tend to be more limited, but are largest among those likely most in need of reskilling. Moreover, we show that treated jobseekers altered their job search behaviour and became more likely to search a job in a shortage occupation. Ultimately, our results suggest that there is room to encourage unemployed jobseekers to retrain in high-demand occupations. However, information alone will likely be insufficient to stimulate large-scale reskilling of the unemployed.

“Long-term Effects of a Housing Policy Reform”, *with Anne Gielen, Olivier Marie and Tommaso Tulkens*

Abstract: This project investigates the effects of the “Rotterdam Wet”, a Dutch policy that aims at improving the livability in some impoverished neighborhoods by temporarily stopping the influx of disadvantaged individuals. It allows municipalities to deny access to public housing in targeted areas to individuals with certain characteristics deemed undesirable (e.g., those without income from work or with a criminal record). Using rich administrative data, we will estimate the effects of the policy on

neighborhood livability, as well as effects on the socio-economic outcomes of directly and indirectly affected individuals.

"Understanding Reskilling Decisions to Address Mismatch Unemployment", with *Benjamine Dejardin, Alexia Delfino, Raffaella Sadun, and Ilan Tojerow*

Abstract: This project aims at better understanding how individuals make reskilling decisions. We conduct a stated-preference experiment with Belgian unemployed jobseekers to estimate their willingness to pay for a broad set of training attributes, which we validate with actual training choices.

"Finding the Perfect Employment Fit: Mismatch Unemployment and Occupational Training Programs", with *Benjamine Dejardin and Ilan Tojerow*

Abstract: This project aims at (i) developing a tool that predicts which jobseekers could most benefit from given training programs, and (ii) studying how to best encourage individuals to enroll in these training programs.

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

2024	Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Postdoctoral Fellowship (€200,000) for the project "Institutional Discrimination in (Explicit) Action: How Policies Shape Inequalities" <i>European Commission</i>
2024	PDR grant (€200,000) for the project "Finding the Perfect Employment Fit: Mismatch Unemployment and Occupational Training Programs" (co-PI with I. Tojerow) <i>Belgian National Science Foundation (FRS-FNRS)</i>
2023	3-Year Postdoctoral Research Fellowship (on leave), <i>Belgian National Science Foundation (FRS-FNRS)</i>
2022; 2021	Research Visit Fellowship <i>Belgian National Science Foundation (FRS-FNRS)</i>
2019	4-Year PhD Fellowship <i>Belgian National Science Foundation (FRS-FNRS)</i>

TEACHING

2024 – 2025	FEB-13065 Seminar Economics of the Public Sector <i>Erasmus University Rotterdam</i>
2024	ECON-S-414 Advanced topics in Public Economics <i>Université libre de Bruxelles</i>
2018 – 2021	ECON-S-301 Introduction to Public Economics (Teaching Assistant) <i>Université libre de Bruxelles</i>

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

2024	Conferences: Bristol Applied Economics Meetings (Bristol), LEER (Leuven), Advances in Field Experiments (London), ZEW Workshop on Research with and within organizations (Mannheim), 7th LISER and IDSC of IZA Workshop: Matching Workers and Jobs Online (Esch-sur-Alzette), MORSE conference (Maastricht), AASLE (Bangkok). Seminars: ROA Maastricht University, Erasmus University Rotterdam Brown Bag Seminar.
2023	Conferences: SOLE (Philadelphia), ESPE (Belgrade), Belgian Day for Labour Economists (Brussels). Seminars: Turku School of Economics Research Seminar, Erasmus University Rotterdam Brown Bag Seminar.
2022	Conferences: Belgian Day of Labor Economists (Brussels), Field Days (Cologne), Dulbea-ROA Workshop on Experiments on Information Frictions and Job Search (Brussels), EEA (Milan), EALE (Padova), 4th QMUL Economics and Finance Workshop for PhD & Post-doctoral Students (London). Seminars: Ghent University, Université Saint-Louis – CEREC, University of Antwerp, CREST, CEBRIG.
2021	Conferences: EALE (online), 20th Journées Louis-André Gérard-Varet (Marseille), ESPE (online), SOLE (online), IES Applied Economics Conference (online). Seminars: Erasmus School of Economics Brown Bag Seminar, ECARES internal seminar, National Bank of Belgium, KU Leuven Brussels, LISER, INAMI.
Before 2021	Conferences: EEA, Journées des Economistes de la Santé Français, DULBEA Workshop on the Economics of Disability. Seminars: UCLouvain, INAMI-RIZIV, CEB Brown Bag Seminar.

OTHER PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

2024	Co-organizer of the 37 th Annual Conference of the European Society of Population Economics (Rotterdam)
2023 – 2025	Co-organizer of the “Research on Monday” seminar series at the Economics Department of Erasmus University Rotterdam
2022	Co-organizer of the Dulbea-ROA Workshop on Experiments on Information Frictions and Job Search
2019	Member of the Local Organizing Committee of the 24 th Spring Meeting of Young Economists

MISCELLANEOUS

Languages	French – English	Native
	Dutch	Intermediate
	Spanish	Basic
Software skills	Statistical packages	STATA
	Communication packages	LATEX, Microsoft Office